

# ENG508

## Nov (2K24)

### Recent Papers

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#### Define holism with example.

A word is defined in terms of some of the very words which help us to define. This view is similar to ‘meaning holism’ (Quine, 1960) – the meaning of a word/phrase/ sentence depends on its relationship with other words, e.g. part of what makes up the meaning of ‘tall’ is that it is opposed to the meaning of ‘short’. Holist theory tends to be functional in the sense that it is some aspect of the uses of a piece of language which makes for its meaning. If you call something ‘tall’, you should be willing to call it ‘not short’.

Meaning holism may be correct in a way, it does not provide a basis for the scientific study of linguistic meaning. That is why; it has not been appreciated by formal semanticists (Portner, 2005, p. 3-5)

#### Define mood and its type subjunctive mood and imperative mood.

Mood is the quality of verb which conveys a writer’s attitude or feelings towards a subject (Saeed, 2004). Mood also shows the feelings of a speaker at time of

speaking. For example, it may rain tomorrow. 'In this example, the speaker's attitude is uncertain about the rain. There are different types of moods:

**Subjunctive moods** contrast with indicative moods because there is an element of uncertainty in subjunctive moods. These are used for wishes, beliefs, exhortations, etc. e.g. May you live long! (Saeed, 2004)

**Imperative moods** make direct commands or requests. For example, show me the money.

### **What is Core vocabulary?**

Each language has a core vocabulary of more frequent and basic words are widely used in foreign language teaching. The core vocabulary could be used to trace lexical links between languages to establish family relationships among them. The implication of this approach is that the membership of core vocabulary will be the same or similar for all languages. Swadesh originally proposed a 200-word list which was later narrowed down to the 100-word list (see Saeed, 2014: 77).

### **Examples of Core Vocabulary Words**

- **Pronouns:** I, you, it, they
- **Verbs:** go, do, make, have
- **Adjectives:** good, big, small, happy
- **Prepositions:** in, on, at, with

### **Repetition concern with linguistic.**

The three concerns with repetition in linguistic studies discussed in the handouts are:

**Lexical Cohesion:** Repetition is a tool for connecting ideas in a text. It helps maintain coherence by repeating key words or phrases, which links parts of the text together.

**Avoidance of Redundancy:** While repetition can help with clarity, it's important to avoid unnecessary repetition that could disrupt the flow of communication. Using alternative linguistic devices like substitution or ellipsis can help avoid this.

**Stylistic Effect:** Repetition can also serve a stylistic function, adding emphasis or rhythm to the speech or writing. However, too much repetition can make the text monotonous, so it should be used carefully for impact without overdoing it.

### **Reasons behind introducing conceptual and procedural distinctions in relevance.**

The conceptual and procedural distinctions in relevance were introduced by Diane Blakemore (1987) to account for differences in the meanings of regular content words and discourse connectives. Conceptual meaning refers to the content or concepts conveyed by words (like "dog" or "red"), whereas procedural meaning refers to words that guide how the information should be processed (such as "but," "so," "therefore"). This distinction helps explain how words like "but" or "so" influence the way listeners interpret the context of a conversation.

These distinctions are important because they clarify how language can simultaneously carry information and guide the listener on how to use that information within the conversation, reducing cognitive effort for comprehension.

### **What is Linguistic botanizing?**

Austin organized a group of philosophers whose work is known as ordinary language philosophy. The prevailing method was 'linguistic botanizing'; to see the distinctions made by ordinary language on the assumption that the way people speak makes many subtle distinctions, worthy of philosophical investigation. These philosophers were drawn into thinking about questions such as 'what saying or stating involves' and 'what else speakers do with language'.

### **Objections of Grice model.**

Two main objections to Grice's Cooperative Principle are:

Assuming Everyone is Always Cooperative: Grice's model assumes that people always cooperate in conversations, but in real life, people sometimes want to speak independently or avoid certain topics. This means not everyone follows the rules all the time.

Cultural Differences: People from different cultures may understand and use conversation rules in different ways. What might be acceptable in one culture (like being vague or indirect) could be seen as violating the rules in another culture.

These objections highlight that Grice's model doesn't always fit how real conversations happen across different cultures.

### **Explain violating the maxim relation and maxim manner.**

**Violating the maxim relation** – Similarly, in answer to ‘How much did that new dress cost?’ the wife tries to distract him and change the topic saying: I know, let’s go out tonight. Now, where would you like to go? This shows the violation of the maxim of relation.

**Violating the maxim manner** – In answer to ‘How much did that new dress cost?’ if she said that ‘a tiny fraction of my salary, though probably a bigger fraction of the salary of the women that sold it to me’, Hoping that it could be taken as an answer and the matter could be dropped. It is, thus, like the wife answers the question in a way that could be said to be violating the maxim of manner, in that she says everything except what the husband wants to know.

### **Define transitive and intransitive?**

Verbs that have objects are called transitive verbs and those without objects are called Intransitive verbs.

Example:

He ate food. **(Transitive)**,

He laughed. **(Intransitive)**

### **What if semantic is consulted for meaning? Write consequences?**

If semantics is consulted for meaning, it can lead to several consequences. Semantics focuses on the literal or dictionary meanings of words, which may result in an overly rigid interpretation of language. This approach often overlooks the role of context, tone, and speaker intent, which are crucial for understanding implied or non-literal meanings in real-life communication. Additionally, semantics alone cannot effectively handle ambiguity, idiomatic expressions, or

cultural nuances, which are key aspects of natural language use. As a result, relying solely on semantics may provide an incomplete understanding and fail to capture the subtleties and complexities of human interaction. For a comprehensive grasp of meaning, pragmatics must also be considered.

### **Criticism of Speech Act Theory.**

Speech Act Theory, developed by philosophers J.L. Austin and later expanded by John Searle, analyzes language as a form of action rather than mere conveyance of information.

While Speech Act Theory has been instrumental in understanding the performative nature of language, its limitations in addressing cultural variability, power dynamics, and the nuances of everyday communication suggest a need for more context-sensitive and flexible approaches.

### **What is relevance between cognitively oriented (human Psychology) and pragmatic?**

Cognitively oriented human psychology provides the foundation for understanding how individuals process, interpret, and produce language in context, which is the core concern of pragmatics. The interplay between cognitive mechanisms (like memory, attention, and inferencing) and pragmatic phenomena (like implicative, context, and intention) illustrates the deep relevance between the two fields.

### **The current state and recent history of pragmatics.**

The current state and recent history of pragmatics are too diverse and complex to describe briefly; A few areas of interest may be picked out. Early in the modern period, disagreement on the principles that govern communication led to fragmentation of the field into Griceans, neo-Griceans and relevance theorists. There are also pragmatic theorists who work primarily on speech acts. From the 1970s, many theorists have been interested in developing formal accounts of phenomena, particularly scalar implicature, presupposition, and conventional implicature. This work is now known as formal pragmatics and has close links to dynamic approaches to semantics such as Discourse Representation Theory.